

CJ PHILIP

# My Creative Process



*First published by CJ PHILIP – Productions – 2026*

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*First edition*

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# What Is this

Hello Dear reader. This *thing* is a document where I discuss my creative process. It will probably be updated but hey lets get into this.



## Write a bad one first.

Lets start with my writing process. What my process involves dear reader, is that I write through as fast as possible getting down the main plot, characters and events. This allows me to have a basic version on which to base the actual first draft. Think of it like in graphic design where you will draw or create a thumbnail, a mock up of what the eventual design will be.

This first write through is rarely any good per say but it enables me to rough out the world building, character motivations and plot. From there I can develop each point into something more impactful. For example in my rough draft of my first book I had the plot thrust into motion by a prophesy. When I was reading through this I realised that this was both cliché and didn't actually provide a reason why my male protagonist would actually agree to the quest. So when I came to that section in the actual first draft, I desired to develop the thing that thrusts the story into motion from a generic prophesy, to a more personal motivation to the male protagonist.

Additionally this rough draft may include scene that are redundant. An example of this in my rough draft, was that I had a scene where my male protagonist is fixing an engine... It did some character development, but the scene in its very concept was unnecessary. So I took the character development, that was

present in this scene and reallocated it in other locations in the book.

Now dear readers I can hear you asking, why not just write a good first draft... Well that's just not how my brain does things. I prefer to have a messy version to develop.

Another Issue I identified from my rough draft is that I hadn't actually made a magic system per say. I just had magic, it was just there. It had no form or structure. No reason why a spell worked one way and not another. So I went back to the drawing board and developed a magic system with rules that I know, in order to write it consistently.

Now dear read please indulge me as I go on a bit of a rant.

## AI - The issues with the modern world

Now some of you may be saying, "Well CJ if you have the basic plot written down why not just use something like Claude or ChatGPT to turn it into a proper story."

Well if you are asking that, first of all. Touch grass. Secondly, the reason I don't do that is because AI in it's very nature is generic, it is based on the statistically most probably next word. I don't want a generic story. I want **my** story. An AI would not understand the dark themes, included in my story. The human depth, the messiness of human psychology, the pain of fear and the sadness of loss. AI would blunt these aspects and output another basic fantasy romp.

Further AI would ruin my characters, it would turn my male protagonist into a Gary Stu, a generic hero figure. The clean shaven goody two shoes. HE is not. He is a deeply flawed young man, just trying to make his way through the world.

Additionally what AI does with Female characters, honestly it

is revolting. I think there is something wrong with the training data. I mean AI is inherently wrong it wastes water, steals the hard work of hundreds- thousands of real artists and authors. But the pattern I have noticed with the training data it has evidently received on how to write women discuss me. AI seems to think that what a woman is is an object of attraction. A person with no real agency. No real personality. No real character! My female protagonist isn't some object to be won. She is not a sack of flesh with no goals. She is an intelligent, formidable, academic, who has her own internal struggle and arc.

Woo, geez, sorry about that. Calm down CJ calm down. Right.

Furthermore AI would not understand the social, infrastructural and geological foundations of my world. It would smooth out the strangeness, and essentially turn it into medieval Europe. Which A. isn't what the world is & B. would be Boring.

BACK to actual writing process then.

\* \* \*

I would like to say to any aspiring author out there, keep a notebook with you at all times. Sometimes your out and about during the day and an idea will pop into your head. Why Just today, I was walking down to Tesco and the idea came to me that one of my side characters needed more to do so he could do XXXX, not telling you for spoiler reasons of course. It could be a character beat, a bit of dialogue or a whole scene.

Additionally, addressing the ever prevalent problem of writers block. My best advice on how to solve it is to go on a walk. Now I go on a walk at least once a day, but you do not need to do this.

Let me say this again for all in the back. YOU. DO. NOT. NEED.  
TO. WALK. EVERY. DAY.

Got it?

The fresh air, and exercise will get your brain moving. Furthermore you can take inspiration from the world around you for environmental details.

\* \* \*



## Draw Your Damn Characters!!! (Or don't, it's up to you)

The Art. I draw my own art.

Is that because I like drawing?

Yes.

Is it also because I don't have money to pay a better artist?

Yes.

Why do I need the art?

I am so glad you asked dear reader. I use the art to ensure character consistency. For example let me show you an Image of my Sona (Stylised version of me).



Imagine this was a character. Having this art would ensure that I keep his design consistent. He has green cargo trousers, purple grey shoes, a blue hoodie. Oh and wings. Having this art ensures I keep these aspects consistent. It's important that you keep aspects of characters consistent when writing because otherwise, the reader will notice.

Now of course this character besides the wings is very basic isn't he, but applying this to fantasy, sci-fi and fiction in general. Well you've seen how complex character designs can get. Think your **Sephiroths** (Who I'm not sure if I can add art of?) his design features (This is based on what I can see, I haven't played any of

the Final Fantasy games yet, love his design though) his flowing black coat, the metallic pauldrons, the black leather shoes, the black trousers. The x strap on his chest, the black trousers and under-armour (of some variety) , the rings around his wrists, his glowing grey/ silver hair, oh and his wings of course. His design has a lot of very specific details, which inform his character, story and personality.

When I am writing my characters I want to ensure this consistency in their visual design not simply because, well that's what you are meant to do, but also because the characters' designs are deeply linked to them as characters.

